



Get gentle exercise, such as walking or swimming, which are ideal before, during, and after pregnancy.

LIFESTYLE CHANGES

If you smoke, you should quit (so should your partner) for health reasons. Once you're pregnant, not smoking will reduce the risk of miscarriage, stillbirth, premature birth, low birth weight, and sudden infant death.

There are at least 30 chemicals in cigarette smoke that can adversely affect fertility. Because smoking reduces the rate at which cells replicate, it may cause most damage during the first days and weeks of pregnancy. Smoking can also have negative effects on sperm and reduce testosterone in men.

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CULTURAL BELIEFS